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Empirical Article

Contextual stress profiles and trajectories of internalizing symptoms among adolescents in Mexican immigrant families

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Abstract

Contextual stress experiences in early adolescents may predict distinct trajectories of depressive symptoms and anxiety across the course of adolescence. Data from 604 Mexican-origin adolescents collected from 2012 to 2020 (54% female; $M_{age} = 12.92$, $SD = 0.92$) showed that youth with high stress levels in multiple domains (*Broadly Stressed*) and those with high stress in language brokering domain only (*Language Brokering Stressed*) had similar levels of internalizing symptoms in early adolescence, and both groups reported higher stress than youth experiencing occasional levels of stress across domains (*Occasionally Environmentally Stressed*). However, youth in the *Language Brokering Stressed* group experienced slightly decreased depressive symptoms from early to late adolescence, while those in the other 2 groups experienced increased or stable internalizing symptoms over time.

Keywords stress, language brokering, Mexican-origin, anxiety, depressive symptoms, adolescence

Lay summary

This study explored how the co-occurrence of different contextual stress (i.e., economic, cultural, neighborhood, and language brokering stress) in early adolescence shapes the mental health of Mexican-origin youth over time. Using data collected across 8 years, this study identified three groups: some adolescents experienced high-contextual stress broadly across many areas of life, others experienced high stress mainly from language brokering for their families, and some experienced only occasional stress across contexts. Youth stressed by language brokering showed similar levels of depressive symptoms as broadly stressed youth at first, but their depressive symptoms slightly decreased over time. In contrast, broadly and occasionally stressed youth continued to report increasing or stable depressive symptoms.

Immigrants represent a fast-growing segment of the U.S. population. More specifically, Mexican immigrants account for the largest immigrant group within the United States, as approximately 25% of all U.S. immigrants are from Mexico (Budiman, 2020). Thus, it is crucial to address the mental health of adolescents within Mexican-origin immigrant families as they constitute a significant contingent of the immigrant populace within the United States. More specifically, Mexican-origin youth of immigrant families may encounter potent risk factors (e.g., discrimination and economic stress) within their environments, which translate to elevated rates of mental health issues relative to youth of other racial/ethnic groups (González et al., 2010). However, research has yet to examine how the co-occurrence of contextual risk factors shapes indices of their mental health longitudinally, and how the

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confluence of these stressors and their prospective mental health impacts are supported by relevant theoretical perspectives related to immigrant-origin children and stress-health linkages (Berens et al., 2017; Nicolai et al., 2013; Suárez-Orozco et al., 2018). Thus, the current study makes several important advances upon extant literature. First, this study assesses patterns of contextual stress (i.e., economic, cultural, neighborhood, and language brokering stress) confronted by Mexican-origin adolescents of immigrant families. Second, the study examines how these unique patterns of contextual stress are associated with initial levels of mental health symptomatology during early adolescence as well as with their trajectories over the course of adolescence. This work stands to provide crucial insights into how unique configurations of contextual stress may place Mexican-origin adolescents at-risk for poor mental health in the long-term.

Contextual stress patterns of Mexican-origin children in immigrant families

The integrative risk and resilience model is a developmental framework which posits that immigrant-origin youth's adaptation is shaped by multiple ecological niches (e.g., families, schools, and neighborhoods) in which immigrant youth develop (Suárez-Orozco et al., 2018). The model identifies the cultural and social assets and stressors specific to immigrant families (e.g., discrimination, economic opportunities, and neighborhood safety) that can be present within youth's environments to mold their developmental processes (Suárez-Orozco et al., 2018). The risks and resources (e.g., cultural values and opportunities for economic mobility) within each of their developmental contexts work in tandem to influence youth's well-being, including their mental health (Suárez-Orozco et al., 2018).

Mexican-origin adolescents as a group, particularly those within immigrant families, encounter a variety of contextual stressors which place them at distinct risk for poor mental health outcomes. In line with Cultural Stress Theory (Meca & Schwartz, 2024), these stressors can emanate from different domains, specifically cultural stressors, economic hardships, harsh neighborhood environments, and navigating between their host and mainstream languages (i.e., language brokering). For example, research has shown that Mexican-origin families experience multiple forms of cultural stress tied to their ethnic status (Flores et al., 2010), being stereotyped as foreigners (Kim et al., 2018), and misfit between their heritage and mainstream U.S. cultures (Wen et al., 2022). Additionally, many Mexican-origin youth within immigrant families assist their parents in navigating daily life in the US by acting as language brokers, where youth utilize their bilingual skills in English and Spanish to interpret and mediate between their heritage and U.S. cultural settings for their parents (Kam & Lazarevic, 2014). While youth with high efficacy in language brokering experiences display positive adjustment outcomes, challenging language brokering experiences (e.g., not understanding how to complete a job application for a family member, unfamiliarity with navigating complex health systems) can exert considerable stress onto Mexican-origin adolescents (Kam & Lazarevic, 2014). Further, Mexican immigrants display lower household incomes relative to the national median (Lopez & Velasco, 2011), which can result from structural constraints to employment (e.g., documentation status) or lower educational attainment, and research has shown that economic disadvantage contributes to worse mental health among Mexican-origin youth (González et al., 2010). Finally, Mexican-origin immigrant families are overrepresented in segregated and low-income neighborhoods that can expose Mexican-origin youth to higher rates of neighborhood violence (Romero et al., 2020).

A wealth of literature substantiates the deleterious impacts of contextual stressors (e.g., discrimination) on Mexican-origin youth's psychological well-being (Seaton et al., 2022; Zeiders, 2017). However, most studies have assessed the linkages between these stressors with poorer mental health individually, yet Mexican-origin youth can encounter multiple contextual stressors simultaneously. McLaughlin et al. (2021) elaborate on issues within early-life adversity research which arise from solely focusing on individual stress exposures (i.e., specificity models), as these studies fail to acknowledge how youth experience multiple adversities in tandem which can be consequential for prospective health outcomes. While scholars have attempted to remedy this using cumulative-risk approaches (e.g., cumulative stress count scores), cumulative-risk methodologies also mask important aspects of how youth experience multiple sources of stress simultaneously (McLaughlin et al., 2021). For example, a study on Mexican-origin youth examined the effects of early-adolescent environmental stress (a composite measure of neighborhood criminal events, neighborhood quality dissatisfaction, and discrimination experiences) on late-adolescent anxiety, and found that greater environmental stress exposure was directly and indirectly related to late-adolescent anxiety via cognitive control (Tsai et al., 2020). However, operationalizing environmental stress as a composite score does not illuminate what specific sources of stress may be driving youth's environmental stress levels, and potential variation in how environmental stress is experienced (e.g., some youth may have experienced high discrimination experiences, while others experienced occasional levels of neighborhood criminal events and discrimination experiences). Thus, identifying how these stressors can uniquely co-occur, and perhaps uniquely relate to later psychological outcomes, is crucial to elucidate the mental health impacts of contextual stress patterns. This study utilizes person-centered approaches, specifically latent profile analysis (LPA), to identify distinct configurations of contextual stress in which Mexican-origin youth may be developing (e.g., broadly high or occasionally stressed or excessive stress in certain domains(s) such as high-economic, language brokering, neighborhood, or cultural stress).

Mental health and domain-specific stressors

Building upon the integrative risk and resilience model, et al. (2 McLaughlin et al. (2021) and other stress theorists (Nicolai et al., 2013) encourage examining how domains of or particular categories of co-occurring stressors may be more detrimental to mental health, such as increased internalizing and depressive symptoms. Thus, there is growing scholarship examining how mental health outcomes can vary depending on configurations of stress exposure among diverse youth and young adult samples (Chen et al., 2024; Goings et al., 2022). For example, Goings et al. (2022) leveraged LPA to examine the psychosocial effects of contextual stress patterns among African-American emerging adults, spanning

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perceived stress, daily stress, community disadvantage, parent–child conflict, racial discrimination, and childhood trauma. The findings revealed unique stress typologies, including a *childhood trauma* profile characterized by the highest levels of childhood trauma combined with contextual risk, a *high-contextual risk* profile which featured high levels of contextual risk but no childhood trauma, and a *low-contextual risk* profile. The findings revealed that youth in the *childhood trauma* profile fared worse across a range of psychosocial indices, which reemphasizes the importance of utilizing methodologies that can capture the exposure level, type, and co-occurrence of diverse stressors.

Thus, when considering the stress landscape of Mexican-origin youth, it is crucial to consider the implications of stress exposure from multiple aspects of their environments. For example, systemic inequities produce structural-level stressors which marginalize racial/ethnic minoritized populations in the US like Mexican-origin communities (e.g., cultural stressors, economic deprivation, and neighborhood stress). For instance, cultural stressors like discrimination have been conceptualized as a persistent social stressor experienced by racial/ethnic minorities (Sutin et al., 2016). Additionally, economic deprivation and neighborhood stress (i.e., exposure to violence) are also potent sources of stress relating to social disadvantage to which racial/ethnic minority populations are disproportionately exposed.

In contrast, family role-based stressors, particularly language brokering, may exert more nuanced effects. Although brokering can be stressful, the meaning it provides when serving as a cultural bridge or family helper can lessen the perceived burden of stressors and improve psychological adjustment (Burke & Stets, 2009). Studies show that Mexican-origin youth can appraise language brokering experiences in a way where they have more agency and personal meaning as they are supporting their family members. Over the course of adolescence, the toll of language brokering demands may be offset by a stronger sense of language brokering efficacy (i.e., adolescents' perceptions of being skilled at language brokering, Kim et al., 2017). Moreover, despite the burdens imposed by language brokering, Mexican-origin youth can conceptualize language brokering as a central component of their identity, and/or a responsibility that enhances closeness to their parents (Kim et al., 2017). Taken together, language brokering may compromise mental health in early adolescence, but as youth gain efficacy in language brokering and align their identity with language brokering over time, their mental health outcomes could improve (Kim et al., 2017). Therefore, it is necessary to examine how underlying typologies of stressors with potentially different combinations of structural stressors (i.e., cultural, economic, neighborhood stressors) and family role-based stressors (i.e., language brokering stressors) may uniquely relate to mental health outcomes in early adolescence and over time among Mexican-origin adolescents.

Mental health trends by contextual stress patterns for Mexican-origin adolescents

The biological embedding model (Berens et al., 2017) explicates how stress exposure early in the life course evokes psychological, physiological, and pathogenic responses that lead to poor health in adulthood. In other words, early exposure to stress places individuals on trajectories of risk for suboptimal mental health over the life course, necessitating a longitudinal view. Moreover, adolescence is a particularly important developmental window in which to examine the prospective mental health consequences of contextual stressors (Blakemore & Mills, 2014). Normative changes in the anatomical structure of the brain renders adolescents particularly vulnerable to the deleterious effects of stress, as evidenced by the increased prevalence of mental health issues (e.g., depression and anxiety) over the course of adolescence (Blakemore & Mills, 2014). Research has yet to assess how distinct profiles of contextual stressors potentially influence Mexican-origin youth's mental health *across the developmental period of adolescence*, which is a notable gap in the literature addressed by the current study.

The current study

The current study extends existing research by examining the co-occurrence of contextual stressors faced by Mexican-origin youth of immigrant families, elucidating how these unique patterns of contextual stress relate to trajectories of mental health across adolescence. This approach can illustrate how configurations of contextual stress in early adolescence place Mexican-origin youth on trajectories of higher vs. lower risk for poorer mental health (i.e., depressive and anxiety symptoms). To this end, the current study conducted an exploratory examination of the following two research objectives utilizing data from Mexican immigrant families with language brokering children. First, using LPA, the study sought to identify unique configurations of contextual stressors spanning four domains: ethnic/cultural (i.e., ethnic discrimination, ethnic victimization, cultural misfit, foreigner stress, discrimination because of skin color, and discrimination in academic settings), neighborhood (i.e., neighborhood violence and insecurity), language brokering (i.e., language brokering stress for mothers/fathers in different places and for different materials), and family economics (i.e., arguing about money, difficulty paying bills, and economic worries). It is hypothesized that specific patterns would emerge characterized by occasionally or high levels of stress across all domains, as well as high levels of stress in specific domains (e.g., high cultural stress, high economic stress, high language brokering stress, and high neighborhood stress).

Second, the study examines trajectories of mental health outcomes (i.e., depressive and anxiety symptoms) among adolescents within each emerging profile, given the increasing prevalence of these disorders particularly during the adolescent period (Blakemore & Mills, 2014). Following domain-specific stress perspectives (Nicolai et al., 2013), it is hypothesized that contextual stress profiles marked by high levels of stress across all domains or profiles with high levels of structural stressors (e.g., high cultural stress, high neighborhood stress, and/or high economic stress) would exert the most detrimental effect initially during early adolescence and over time through late adolescence where depressive and anxiety symptoms are consistently high or steadily increasing among Mexican-origin youth. Conversely, contextual stress profiles with lower levels of stress across all domains or higher levels of family role-based stress (i.e., high language brokering stress) would relate to lower initial levels of depressive and anxiety symptoms in early adolescence and possibly decline over the transition to late adolescence. The present study was not preregistered.

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Methods

Participants

This study utilized three waves of data from a longitudinal study designed to understand language brokering-related experiences and contexts among Mexican immigrant families.[1] A priori power analysis was not conducted at the time of initial data collection, and all available samples were included given attrition across waves. The participants consisted of 604 adolescents (54% female) from Mexican immigrant families residing in and around a major metropolitan area in central Texas. During Wave 1 data collection (2012–2015), the participants ranged from 11 to 15 years old ($M_{age}=12.92$, $SD=0.92$) and were in Grades 6–8. The majority of adolescents lived with both of their parents (76%) and were born in the United States (75%). The median family income fell within the range of $20,001 to $30,000. In Wave 2, 80% of the adolescents ($n=483$, 55% female; $M_{age}=13.72$, $SD=0.90$) remained as participants. For Wave 3, 55% of adolescents ($n=334$, 56% female; $M_{age}=17.62$, $SD=1.05$) continued their participation. Attrition analysis was conducted to elucidate the pattern of missing data across waves. The results indicated that families remaining in the study at Wave 2 exhibited higher maternal education levels [$t(591)=2.41$, $p=.016$], and those who continued from Waves 2 to 3 were younger adolescents compared with those who did not [$t(481)=2.96$, $p=.003$]. Similarly, youth who participated in Wave 3 were younger [$t(602)=3.51$, $p<.001$] and had mothers with higher education attainment [$t(591)=-3.45$, $p=.001$] than those who participated in Wave 1 but not 3. These demographic variables were included as covariates in the main analyses. Youth who participated in Wave 2 or 3 did not differ from youth who dropped out of the study at Wave 2 or 3 in terms of any Wave 1 stress experiences or internalizing symptoms (p ranges from .10 to .98).

Procedure

The recruitment process started with research assistants identifying potential participants through public records, school presentations, and community outreach. Mexican-origin families with at least one child capable of translating for their parents were eligible for the larger study. Research assistants would arrange a preliminary meeting with eligible families before the formal data collection. Family consent (from parents) and assent (from children) were obtained during the preliminary meeting if the family decided to participate. In the formal data collection, research assistants would conduct a home-visit interview with the family at each wave. All questions/items in the interview were provided in both English and Spanish. These items were initially translated from English to Spanish and then back-translated by bilingual research assistants to ensure translation accuracy. Bilingual and bicultural interviewers read the questions aloud to the participants in their preferred language (English or Spanish) and recorded the responses on a laptop computer. Each participating family received compensation of $60 at Wave 1 (2012–2015) and $90 at Waves 2 (2013–2016) and 3 (2017–2020). The study procedure was approved by the Institutional Review Board at the University of Texas at Austin.

[1] This dataset has been used in prior publications to examine related topics (see Supplemental note on prior publications).

Measures

Adolescents self-reported their contextual stress experiences at Wave 1 and their depressive symptoms and anxiety at Waves 1, 2, and 3.

Ethnic/cultural stressors

Ethnic discrimination

Ethnic discrimination was measured by the nine-item Everyday Discrimination Scale (Williams et al., 1997). Adolescents provided self-reports regarding the frequency of encountering unjust or prejudicial treatment due to their Mexican background on a scale ranging from 1 (*never*) to 4 (*frequently*). Sample items include "I am treated with less respect than other people because I am Mexican." Higher average scores indicate greater levels of discrimination based on being of Mexican origin ($\alpha=.88$).

Ethnic victimization

Ethnic victimization was measured by a five-item scale from a prior study (Kim et al., 2011). Adolescents self-reported the frequency of encountering ethnic victimization, or the experience of being a target or victim of harassment or violent acts due to their Mexican background on a scale ranging from 1 (*never*) to 4 (*frequently*). Sample items include "People break or destroy my things because I am Mexican." Higher average scores represent a greater level of victimization related to being of Mexican origin ($\alpha=.84$).

Cultural misfit

Cultural misfit was evaluated using a four-item measure adapted from the misfit subscale of the Cultural Estrangement Inventory (Cozzarelli & Karafa, 1998). Adolescents self-reported their agreement on statements such as "My ideas and opinions about important matters tend to differ from most people in this country" on a scale ranging from 1 (*strongly disagree*) to 5 (*strongly agree*). Higher average scores on this scale indicate a heightened sense of cultural misfit ($\alpha=.77$).

Foreigner stress

Foreigner stress was measured by a four-item scale developed by Kim et al. (2018). Adolescents self-reported their agreement on statements such as "When people look at me, they see a foreigner" on a scale ranging from 1 (*strongly disagree*) to 5 (*strongly agree*). Higher average score represents more experiences regarding being perceived as foreigners ($\alpha=.71$).

Discrimination because of skin color

Adolescents self-reported on one item asking, "how frequently do you experience discrimination due to your skin color?" on a scale ranging from 1 (never) to 5 (*always*) (Wang et al., 2022).

Discrimination in academic settings

Discrimination in academic settings was measured by three items from previous studies (Fisher et al., 2000; McNeilly et al., 1996). Adolescents reported their agreement with statements such as "teachers and students assume I'm less intelligent" on a scale ranging from 1 (*strongly disagree*) to 5 (*strongly agree*). Higher average scores represent more discriminatory experiences in academic settings ($\alpha=.64$).

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Neighborhood stressors

Neighborhood violence

Neighborhood violence was measured by three items from the Survey of Children's Exposure to Community Violence (Richters & Saltzman, 1990). Adolescents reported their perceptions of violent incidents in the neighborhood on statements like "people in my neighborhood are picked up, arrested, or taken away by the police" on a scale ranging from 1 (*never*) to 5 (*always*). Higher average scores represent higher levels of perceived neighborhood violence ($\alpha = .83$).

Neighborhood insecurity

Neighborhood insecurity was measured by four items (Kim et al., 2009). Adolescents reported their agreement on statements such as "My neighborhood is safe for children during the daytime" on a scale ranging from 1 (*strongly disagree*) to 5 (*strongly agree*). Responses were reverse coded and averaged to represent the level of neighborhood insecurity ($\alpha = .73$).

Language brokering stressors

Language brokering stress for mothers/fathers in different settings

Adolescents self-reported how stressful they were when translating for mothers and fathers in seven different settings, separately, on a scale ranging from 1 (*not stressful*) to 5 (*extremely stressful*). The settings were adapted from a previous study (Tse, 1995) and include "at home," "at your school/at parent and teacher conferences," "at stores (supermarkets)," "at the bank," "at restaurants," "at the doctor's office," and "at government offices." Responses were coded as missing, instead of zero, if adolescents indicated "I do not translate for my mother/father at this place." Because participant recruitment in the larger study specifically targeted adolescents with language brokering experience, all participants in the analytic sample had engaged in language brokering in at least one setting, although not necessarily in all places listed. Coding as missing can indicate lack of language brokering experience in that specific setting, while coding as zero would inaccurately suggest an absence of stress in a context where no translation actually occurred. Higher average scores represent higher levels of stress in language brokering across different settings ($\alpha_{\text{brokering for mother}} = .90$; $\alpha_{\text{brokering for father}} = .92$).

Language brokering stress for mothers/fathers for different materials

Adolescents self-reported how stressful they were when translating for mothers and fathers for 11 different materials, separately, on a scale ranging from 1 (*not stressful*) to 5 (*extremely stressful*). The materials include "your homework," "phone calls," "report cards or school progress reports/other school information," etc. (Shen et al., 2020). Responses were coded as missing if adolescents indicated, "I do not translate this for my mother/father." Higher average scores represent higher levels of stress in language brokering across different materials ($\alpha_{\text{brokering for mother}} = .92$; $\alpha_{\text{brokering for father}} = .93$).

Family economic stressors

Family argument about money

Arguing about money was assessed by three items adapted from a previous study (Mistry et al., 2009). Adolescents self-reported how frequently they encountered situations such as "Did you and your parents disagree or get upset about money?" on a scale ranging from 1 (*never*) to 5 (*always*). Higher average scores represent more frequent occurrence of financial related arguments in the family ($\alpha = .71$).

Difficulty paying bills

Adolescents self-reported on one item asking, "How much of a problem did your family have because your parents did not have enough money to buy things your family needs or wants?" on a scale ranging from 1 (*not at all*) to 5 (*very*) (Mistry et al., 2009).

Economic worries

Adolescents self-reported their perceptions on family worries about their family economics on one item asking, "How upset or worried were your parent(s) because they did not have enough money to pay for things?" on a scale ranging from 1 (*not at all*) to 5 (*very*) (Mistry et al., 2009).

Internalizing symptoms

Depressive symptoms

Adolescents self-reported their depressive symptoms for the past week on the 20-item Center for Epidemiologic Studies Depression Scalescale developed by Radloff (1977). Sample items include "I did not feel like eating; my appetite was poor." Responses were recorded on a scale ranging from 1 (*rarely or none*) to 4 (*most or all*) and were averaged to represent the level of depressive symptoms ($\alpha_{\text{wave 1}} = .83$; $\alpha_{\text{wave 2}} = .84$; $\alpha_{\text{wave 3}} = .87$).

Anxiety

Adolescents reported the frequency of experiencing anxiety-related symptoms on four items from previous studies (Reynolds & Richmond, 1978; Spitzer et al., 2006). Sample items include "difficulty relaxing." Responses were recorded on a scale ranging from 1 (*not at all*) to 4 (*nearly every day*) and were averaged to represent levels of anxiety ($\alpha_{\text{wave 1}} = .75$; $\alpha_{\text{wave 2}} = .82$; $\alpha_{\text{wave 3}} = .81$).

Covariates

Adolescents' age, gender, and nativity reported at Wave 1 were included as covariates in the study given that those basic demographic variables have been shown to be related to youth psychological adjustment (Vega et al., 2009). Maternal education was also included given the results of the attrition analysis, which was measured by maternal self-reported highest education level on a scale ranging from 1 (*no formal schooling*) to 11 (*finished graduate degree*) at Wave 1.

Analysis plan

First, descriptive analysis and correlation of study variables were conducted in SPSS 22.0 to understand the distribution of variables and bivariate associations between variables. All models that follow were estimated in Mplus 8.3. Latent profile analysis was conducted using the scores of contextual stress at Wave 1 (i.e., 15 variables). Second, a set of LPA models (i.e., six models with one to six profiles, respectively) was estimated, and the optimal profile number was determined based on model fit indices and the conceptual interpretation of profiles. The selection of the optimal profile solution was based on model fit indices, i.e., the Lo–Mendell–Rubin (LMR) test, entropy, Akaike information criteria (AIC), Bayesian information criteria (BIC), and adjusted BIC, based on the recommendations of Nylund et al. (2007). Third, unconditional growth curve models with intercepts and linear

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slopes were estimated for adolescents' depressive symptoms and anxiety, separately, to estimate the overall change trajectories of depressive symptoms and anxiety from early to late adolescence.

The growth curve models were scaled by time intervals between data collection waves, with Wave 1 set as the reference point (time = 0). Fourth, multiple group analyses were conducted to examine group differences in the initial level (i.e., intercept) and change trajectories (i.e., slope) of depressive symptoms and anxiety across different contextual stress profiles. Anxiety and depressive symptoms were modeled separately. To examine differences in developmental trajectories across profiles, new model parameters were generated to estimate pairwise comparisons across contextual stress profiles in terms of intercepts and slopes for both anxiety and depressive symptoms. These parameters were then tested against zero to determine whether the observed differences in initial levels (intercepts) and rates of change over time (slopes) between each pair of profiles were statistically significant. Covariates (i.e., adolescents' age, gender, nativity, and maternal education) were included in the multiple group analysis, and missing data were handled by full information maximum likelihood estimation.

Monte Carlo simulations were used to estimate the statistical power for LPA and multiple group analysis. Tein et al. (2013) emphasized several key factors that influence statistical power, including the number of latent classes, sample size, number of indicators, and the degree of separation between classes. The current study was based on a sample of 604 participants, included 15 indicators, and assumed moderate to large class separation (Cohen's $d = 0.80–1.50$). According to Tein et al. (2013), similar conditions, including a sample size between 500 and 1,000, similar number of indicators, and moderate to large class separation, can achieve over 80% statistical power in LPA to accurately detect a three-class solution. This level of power applies to multiple fit indices, including the BIC, sample-size adjusted BIC, LMR, adjusted LMR, and bootstrap likelihood-ratio test, with the exception of the AIC, which tends to overestimate the number of classes. All model fit indices were taken into account when comparing alternative class solutions in the current study to ensure a comprehensive and robust evaluation of model fit. Because no prior studies reported class separation estimates for a similar population and set of indicators, the actual class separation in the current study was calculated based on the LPA results to confirm that it falls within the expected range of a moderate to large class separation (Cohen's $d = 0.80–1.5$) assumed in the power analysis. For the multigroup analyses, a Monte Carlo simulation–based power analysis was conducted in Mplus using logistic regression and assuming four covariates. The results indicated statistical power ranging from 80% to 99% to detect small (0.20) to very small (0.15) effect sizes for the influence of contextual stress profiles on adolescents' depressive and anxiety symptom intercepts and slopes.

To further examine the robustness and specificity of the findings, two sets of sensitivity analyses were conducted using a variable-centered approach. First, a composite cumulative contextual stress score was created based on multiple stress indicators included in the study. Each indicator was rescaled to a 0–1 range and then averaged to represent the overall level of contextual stress. Second, domain-specific stress scores were generated by averaging items within each stress domain: cultural stress, neighborhood stress, language brokering stress, and economic stress. Growth curve models were used to examine how the composite and domain-specific stress scores predicted initial levels and trajectories of internalizing symptoms (i.e., anxiety and depressive symptoms) over time.

Results

Descriptive information and correlation of study variables are presented in Table S1. Overall, contextual stressors experienced at Wave 1 were positively related to anxiety and depressive symptoms. Specifically, ethnic/cultural- and neighborhood-level stressors were related to higher levels of anxiety and depressive symptoms across all three waves, and family-level stressors were related to more anxiety and depressive symptoms mainly in Waves 1 and 2.

Table S2 shows the model fit indices for the LPA of Wave 1 contextual stress. A three-profile solution was selected based on both statistical and conceptual considerations. Model fit indices (loglikelihood, AIC, BIC, and adjusted BIC) leveled off after three profiles, entropy was high (>.90), and the LMR test indicated that three profiles fit the data significantly better than two, while a four-profile model offered no improvement. Conceptually, the three-profile solution captured a distinct group characterized by high language brokering stress that was not evident in the two-profile model. As shown in Figure S1, the three-profile solution includes the *Occasionally Environmentally Stressed* profile (69%; $n = 416$), the *Broadly Stressed* profile (14%; $n = 83$), and the *Language Brokering Stressed* profile (17%; $n = 105$). Table S3 presents the means of all indicators for each profile and the comparison of indicator means across profiles.

In the largest group, the *Occasionally Environmentally Stressed* profile, adolescents reported relatively low to moderate levels of contextual stress compared with the sample average across all indicators across ethnic/cultural, neighborhood, and family levels. However, youth still reported non-negligible levels of neighborhood violence and insecurity, which are stress experiences rooted in environmental contexts. While indicators of cultural misfit and foreigner stress approached the lower end of the scale, there were still occasional elevations above the floor level. In the smallest group, the *Broadly Stressed* profile, adolescents reported relatively high levels of contextual stress across all indicators. In the last group, the *Language Brokering Stressed* profile, adolescents reported similar or slightly higher levels of ethnic/cultural stress as the *Occasionally Environmentally Stressed* profile and lower or similar levels of neighborhood and family economic stress as the *Broadly Stressed* profile but very high levels of language brokering stress (Table S3). The average class separation among the three profiles was 1.04 (Cohen's $d = 1.04$), which aligns with the moderate to large class separation specified in the initial power analysis (Cohen's $d = 0.80–1.04$), providing support that the power analysis was appropriately specified and that the current study had sufficient power (80%) to detect a three-profile solution.

Figure S2 displays spaghetti plots to show variability in youth anxiety and depressive symptoms trajectories from Waves 1 to 3 for each profile. The unconditional growth curve models yielded good model fits for anxiety (CFI = 1.00, confidence interval of RMSEA = [.00, .05], SRMR < .01) and depressive symptoms (CFI = 1.00, confidence interval of RMSEA = [.00, .09], SRMR = .01). On average, adolescents showed a significant increase in anxiety (intercept: $b = 1.69$, SE = 0.02, $p < .001$; slope: $b = 0.03$, SE = 0.01,

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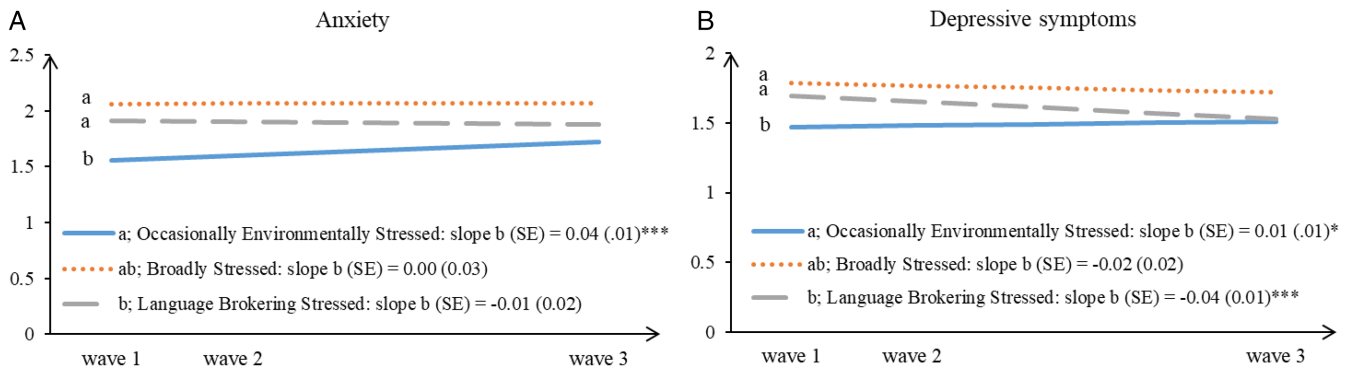

Figure 1 Trajectories of internalizing symptoms of different contextual stress profiles. Note. $N = 604$. Figure 1A is for Anxiety, and Figure 1B is for Depressive Symptoms as the outcomes. Letters before the lines show whether there were significantdifferences in the intercept across profiles. Letters in the legend show whether there were significant differences in the slope across profiles. Profiles with different letters were significantly different for intercepts or slopes. Model fit for anxiety model: Confidence Internal of Root Mean Square Error of Approximation (RMSEA) = [.04, .11], Comparative Fit Index (CFI) = .91, Standardized Root Mean Square Residual (SRMR) = .06; Model fit for depressive symptoms model: Confidence Internal of RMSEA = [.03, .10], CFI = .93, SRMR = .04.

$p < .001$) but stable depressive symptoms (intercept: $b = 1.56$, SE = 0.02, $p < .001$; slope: $b = -.00$, SE = 0.01, $p = .54$) from Waves 1 to 3. There were significant variances in the intercept and slope for anxiety (intercept: $\sigma^2 = 0.22$, SE = 0.02, $p < .001$; slope: $\sigma^2 = 0.01$, SE = 0.01, $p = .03$) and depressive symptoms (intercept: $\sigma^2 = 0.09$, SE = 0.01, $p < .001$; slope: $\sigma^2 = 0.004$, SE = 0.002, $p = .01$). Figure 1shows the change trajectories of anxiety and depressive symptoms from Waves 1 to 3 for each contextual stress profile. Table S4 presents unstandardized coefficients of intercepts and slopes for depressive symptoms and anxiety in each group.

Adolescents in the *Broadly Stressed* or *Language Brokering Stressed* profiles experienced greater initial anxiety (*Broadly Stressed* vs. *Occasionally Environmentally Stressed*: $b = 0.51$, SE = 0.07, $p < .001$; *Language Brokering Stressed* vs. *Occasionally Environmentally Stressed*: $b = 0.36$, SE = 0.06, $p < .001$) and depressive symptoms (*Broadly Stressed* vs. *Occasionally Environmentally Stressed*: $b = 0.32$, SE = 0.05, $p < .001$; *Language Brokering Stressed* vs. *Occasionally Environmentally Stressed*: $b = 0.22$, SE = 0.04, $p < .001$) at Wave 1 compared with the *Occasionally Environmentally Stressed* profile. Additionally, youth in the *Broadly Stressed* profile experienced consistent levels of anxiety and depressive symptoms from Waves 1 to 3.

In addition, adolescents in the *Language Brokering Stressed* profile experienced a steeper decrease or slower increase in anxiety ($b = -0.05$, SE = 0.02, $p = .01$) and depressive symptoms ($b = -0.05$, SE = 0.01, $p < .001$) compared with the *Occasionally Environmentally Stressed* profile. Specifically, youth in the *Language Brokering Stressed* profile experienced stable anxiety and decreased depressive symptoms from Waves 1 to 3, while youth in the *Occasionally Environmentally Stressed* profile experienced increased anxiety and depressive symptoms from Waves 1 to 3. However, it is worth noting that the increased depressive symptoms from Waves 1 to 3 in the *Occasionally Environmentally Stressed* profile was significant with unstandardized coefficients ($b = 0.010$, SE = 0.005, $p = .038$) but marginally significant in standardized coefficients ($\beta = 0.156$, SE = 0.082, $p = .058$). Mplus outputs of the analyses are available at: https://osf.io/bnzda/?view_only=47a1089d5063488e8c85f18664bf29f2.

Sensitivity analyses from variable-centered findings highlight that language brokering stress may represent a distinct form of sociocultural stress (Table S5; see Results Section on Supplemental Material). A type of stress that, while initially distressing, may elicit the development of adaptation over time. This is consistent with the person-centered findings, which showed stable or even decreasing internalizing symptoms among those in the *Language Brokering Stressed* profile. Moreover, the person-centered approach used in the current study offers two key advantages over the variable-centered sensitivity analysis. First, it situates language brokering stress in relation to other co-occurring stressors, rather than examining it in isolation. The person-centered approach identified a subgroup of youth (17%) who experienced high levels of language brokering stress largely independently of other stress. This suggests that the impact the language brokering stress may not merely be a function of cumulative stress exposure. Second, rather than assuming a linear association between stress and adjustment, the person-centered findings revealed that youth in the *Occasionally Environmental Stressed* group showed increasing internalizing symptoms over time. In contrast, youth in the *Broadly Stressed* group exhibited more stable or declining symptoms, potentially reflecting adaptation or a ceiling effect.

Discussion

The psychological well-being of ethnic minority adolescents has been negatively linked with their exposure to contextual stressors. This is in part because environmental effects likely have a more pronounced effect during this period in the life course: adolescence is a time when young people become more aware of contextual risk factors within their family (e.g., economic hardship) with the development of socio-cognitive abilities and become increasingly cognizant of the multiple forms of cultural stress tied to their ethnic and immigrant identities (i.e., discrimination and language brokering) (Flores et al., 2010). Understanding adolescents' contextual stressor experiences is crucial given that psychological health disparities disproportionately affect Mexican-origin youth (González et al., 2010). Indeed, they may encounter greater challenges during adolescence because of potential discrimination related to their ethnic minority and immigrant status, living in more disadvantaged neighborhoods, and engaging in familial

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obligations such as translating for their English-limited parents, which have all been independently linked to greater incidence of internalizing symptoms (Kam & Lazarevic, 2014; Suárez-Orozco et al., 2018). However, the link between different patterned configurations of adolescents' contextual stressors and internalizing symptoms remains relatively underexplored, obscuring vital knowledge about unique challenges faced by potential subgroups and limiting our ability to determine optimal intervention strategies to improve adolescent mental well-being. Using longitudinal data from a sample of Mexican-origin adolescents who engage in translation for their families, the current study examined the links between adolescents' heterogeneous configurations of their contextual stressors and potential trajectorial changes in their internalizing symptoms across adolescence. Results showed that youth exhibited different contextual stress profiles, and the occurrence of such profiles had profound impact on their trajectories of internalizing symptoms.

The use of latent profile analyses allowed the identification of three typologies, which in turn provided support for study hypotheses regarding contextual stress patterns that differed by indicators in terms of high versus low levels of stress; they also offer some level of agreement that adolescents can also exhibit domain-specific areas of contextual stress. Specifically, the largest group of adolescents (69%) in the study (*Occasionally Environmentally Stressed*) experienced occasional levels of contextual stress across all contextual stress domains spanning ethnic/cultural, neighborhood, language brokering, and family economic stress. This finding is intriguing as it suggests that it is more typical that adolescents experienced only occasional levels of contextual stress in comparison with their peers, such as never to rarely experiencing ethnic discrimination, disagreeing about statements regarding neighborhood violence, being not to little stressful in brokering, and perceiving a little to somewhat levels of family economic worries. The fact that most of participants falls into the *Occasionally Environmentally Stressed* group challenges harmful stereotypes (i.e., deficit perspective) that the majority of Mexican-origin adolescents are burdened by extremely high levels of harmful stress and struggle to adjust to living in the United States (Piña-Watson et al., 2016). In the next identified profile (*Broadly Stressed*), adolescents reported experiencing high levels of contextual stress across all measured domains (14%). Given that chronic exposure to contextual risks has been linked to adverse long-term health outcomes, including impairment to the biological systems (e.g., endocrine, and immunity, McEwen & Stellar, 1993), adolescents in this profile may be particularly susceptible to physical and biological health issues. It is of note that the prevalence of occasional and all-high typologies (and the fact that these profiles occupy ~83% of our overall sample) is consistent with existing studies documenting the co-occurrence of multiple contextual risks for Mexican-origin adolescents (Shen et al., 2020) and that young people often face constellations of risks rather than single, isolated adverse experiences (Gach et al., 2018). Rather than compounding different contextual risk factors as one cumulative index (Gach et al., 2018), the current study moves beyond to distinguish multiple contextual stress from different life aspects and take a person-centered approach illustrating and revealing the proportions of different contextual stress patterns. Given the documented deleterious effects of additive risk (i.e., cumulative-risk literature, Evans et al., 2013), study findings provide fresh evidence that the disproportionate exposure to multiple environmental detriments may play a part in compromising Mexican-origin youth's mental well-being.

Notably, the study also identified a subgroup of adolescents (*Language Brokering Stressed*) who reported experiencing moderate levels of contextual stress, but also relatively high levels of stress in domains associated with language translation (17%). The identification of the *Language Brokering Stressed* profile echoes the sentiments put forth by researchers who adopt domain stress perspectives (Nicolai et al., 2013). This finding also supports prior research using LPA among Hispanic/Latino adolescents, in which a unique profile was identified that reflected high levels of language brokering stress and negative sociopolitical experiences (Zeledon et al., 2023). In contrast, contextual stress profile analyses in other ethnic groups have yielded different patterns. For example, a study of African-American adolescents living in rural Georgia identified low- and high-contextual risk profiles, as well as a childhood trauma group (Goings et al., 2022). However, because these African-American youth were not from immigrant families, they are less likely to experience stressors specific to immigrant communities such as language brokering. The presence of the language brokering stress profile in the current study highlights the complexities of Mexican-origin adolescents' lived experiences, where cultural, linguistic, and general stressors collide. These intersecting stressors may not be as prominent in the lives of adolescents from nonimmigrant backgrounds. Language brokering can be burdensome for youth who are thrust into situations where they need to assist their families (Kam & Lazarevic, 2014). The challenges and difficulties in managing complex language brokering settings and materials can be a unique contextual stress that is relatively distinguished from contextual stress in other domains (i.e., ethnic/cultural, neighborhood, and family economic stress).

While the previous study examining contextual stress profiles among Latino adolescents focused on stressors coming from sociopolitical climate and intragroup discrimination (Zeledon et al., 2023), that study did not capture some key interpersonal forms of stress, such as ethnic discrimination (Del Toro et al., 2024). The study by Zeledon et al. (2023) also overlooked contextual stressors related to neighborhood conditions and financial strain, which are commonly experienced by Mexican-origin adolescents. By incorporating stressors from ecological contexts (Bronfenbrenner & Morris, 2006), the current study extends prior work and offers a more comprehensive understanding of the stress landscape and lived experience of Mexican-origin adolescents and their families. Similar to the study by Zeledon et al. (2023), the current findings revealed profiles that varied primarily in terms of overall stress severity, such as *Occasionally Environmentally Stressed* and *Broadly Stressed* profiles. However, only one domain-specific profile emerged in the present study (*Language Brokering Stressed*), compared to two in the study by Zeledon et al. (2023) (*Social Climate* & *Language Brokering Stress*, and *Social Climate and In-group Identity Threat*). The study by Zeledon et al. (2023) suggests that intragroup discrimination, such as being questioned by other Latino individuals about one's heritage identity or being perceived as overly ethnically identified, may represent a distinct type of domain-specific stress that the current study did not assess and deserves further investigation beyond the types of contextual stressor included in the current study.

Critically, the profiles found in this study hold important implications for how patterned profiles of adolescents' contextual stressors are related to their baseline levels of and trajectorial

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changes in anxiety and depressive symptoms from early to late adolescence. As expected, adolescents in the *Broadly Stressed* and *Language Brokering Stressed* profiles experienced greater initial anxiety and depressive symptoms at baseline compared with the *Occasionally Environmentally Stressed* profile. For adolescents who showed a consistent pattern of high stress across all contextual stress domains (i.e., *Broadly Stressed* profile), they also showed highest levels of internalizing symptoms at baseline (Evans et al., 2013), where exposure to multiple contextual risk factors may indicate the presence of increased psychological burden that can result in *and* perpetuate ineffective coping strategies or maladaptive practices (e.g., ineffective cognitive reappraisal and increased rumination) that limit adolescents' ability to effectively buffer against (Lee et al., 2022). This can increase their susceptibility to mental health issues and manifest in high levels of internalizing symptoms. Given also that past research has highlighted how child vulnerabilities and contextual risk factors can function as early precursors of and set the stage for subsequent development (Ashford et al., 2008), it should not come as a surprise that adolescents in the *Broadly Stressed* profile consistently showed highest levels of internalizing symptoms from early to late adolescence. The current study extends the literature and highlights the longitudinal links between exposure to multiple contextual risk factors and adolescent internalizing symptoms (Lee et al., 2022).

Of importance, the study found that adolescents in the *Language Brokering Stressed* profile also showed high levels of baseline internalizing symptoms, echoing domain-specific perspectives on stress (Nicolai et al., 2013), which underscores how specific stressors can exert profound influence on adolescents' mental well-being. Language brokering may be a particularly salient contextual stressor because of the uniqueness and relevance translation has for adolescents and their families (Penn & Witkin, 1994) and a specific proportion of youth likely respond more negatively psychologically in early adolescence when they are met with excessive stress in language brokering demands alongside some other contextual risks, culminating in worse internalizing symptoms. Bearing in mind that adolescence is a time when young people start to view parents as role models for them to learn (rather than deferring to) independent problem-solving and decision-making skills (Willemen et al., 2011), language brokering can push some adolescents into a space where they must take on parental responsibility and assume decision-making responsibilities for the family (i.e., parentification); the corollary is that adolescents might experience the detrimental effects for language brokering more acutely. For instance, they may blame themselves when things do not go well (Kam & Lazarevic, 2014), and such maladaptive cognitions can manifest in less-than-ideal coping strategies that exacerbate their own, and increase adolescents' susceptibility to, internalizing symptoms. Adolescents in the *Language Brokering Stressed* profile showed similarly high levels of internalizing symptoms as adolescents in the *Broadly Stressed* profile in early adolescence. That is, although they differed from adolescents in the *Occasionally Environmentally Stressed* profile only in the domain of language brokering stress, high language brokering stress adolescents had baseline levels of anxiety and depressive symptoms that were not significantly different from adolescents in the *Broadly Stressed* profile. Therefore, experiencing high levels of stress even in one domain of a specific contextual stress can have severe negative repercussions on adolescents' mental well-being.

The silver lining, however, is that youth in the *Language Brokering Stressed* profile experienced stable anxiety and decreased depressive symptoms from Waves 1 to 3. The risk imposed by high language brokering stress may be developmentally specific. That is, language brokering stress in early adolescence may be particularly detrimental concurrently, but its influence then decreases over time as youth become more efficacious in language brokering (Kim, Hou, & Gonzalez, 2017), or perhaps through gaining a sense of meaning and purpose through development of their identities as language brokers across adolescence (Sim et al., 2019). For instance, adolescents in the *Language Brokering Stressed* profile experienced decreased depressive symptoms from early to late adolescence, while those in the *Occasionally Environmentally Stressed* group reported increased anxiety and probably depressive symptoms over time. The slight increase in internalizing symptoms across adolescence displayed by youth in the *Occasionally Environmentally Stressed* profile could represent normative increases in symptomology related to developmental challenges as young people grow older. Nevertheless, longitudinal finding that adolescents in the *Language Brokering Stressed* profile showed stable anxiety and reduced depressive symptoms is at least consistent with study hypothesis.

Despite its initial toll, language brokers can benefit from their role as cultural bridge and family helper, which help lessen the perceived burden and improve their mental health during language brokering. Also, serving as a language broker may also help adolescents gradually build a stronger sense of connection with their parents (Kim et al., 2017). Although language brokering may initially be a source of stress, adolescents' role as language brokers, in which they serve as interpreters, advocates, and cultural bridges for their families, may ultimately become a source of meaning and personal agency (Burke & Stets, 2009), helping reduce the perceived burden over time and positively impact their mental health. Moreover, taking on this family-supportive role may also foster greater closeness with parents (Kim et al., 2017), further offsetting early stress and contributing to more favorable emotional outcomes throughout adolescence. As such, the current findings have implications for and provide directions regarding which stressors to prioritize to better address or improve the mental well-being of Mexican-origin youth from immigrant families (i.e., language brokering stress), as well as the timing of intervention (i.e., early adolescence).

Study findings may provide some evidence for how translation for the family may implicate youths' internalizing symptoms: perhaps, to the extent that youth become increasingly efficacious in translation, they may start to show resilience that buffers against their experienced internalizing symptoms (Kim, Hou, & Gonzalez, 2017). The work here also runs in parallel with contemporary positive psychology work that considers cultural factors (i.e., language brokering); how they can be linked to young people's resilience and strengths, and how these factors collectively propel positive youth development in Latino adolescents (Kuperminc et al., 2009). However, the findings should be interpreted with caution, as the overall mean-level changes in internalizing symptoms across waves were small (e.g., anxiety: Wave 1 = 1.69, Wave 3 = 1.85; depressive symptoms: Wave 1 = 1.56, Wave 3 = 1.55). Although the reduction in depressive symptoms was relatively larger in the *Language Brokering Stressed* profile (from Wave 1 = 1.72 to Wave 3 = 1.50) compared with other profiles (from Wave 1 = 1.84, 1.48 to Wave 3 = 1.76. 1.52 for *Broadly Stressed* and *Occasionally Stressed*,

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respectively), the magnitude of change did not exceed 1 point. Therefore, interpretations regarding the influence of contextual stress profiles on adolescents' internalizing symptoms should avoid overstating the effects.

It is possible that the increased internalizing symptoms in the *Occasionally Environmentally Stressed* group and the decreased anxiety in the *Broadly Stressed* profile may reflect a trend of regression to the average considering their initial levels. However, it is worth noting that although those in the *Broadly Stressed* profile exhibited the highest initial levels of internalizing symptoms, this group consistently maintained elevated levels of internalizing symptoms throughout the adolescent period. This observation underscores the persistence of internalizing symptoms within this subgroup despite the passage of time, rather than the potential regression to average. Perhaps one explanation for why Mexican-origin youth often bear the brunt of health disparities may be explained by the notion that although high levels of a specific risk on its own may exert negligible influence on well-being (i.e., language brokering) in the long run, the effects of this same stressor may be compounded when adolescents are chronically exposed to multiple risk factors (i.e., when youths are also confronted by other contextual stressors, Evans et al., 2013).

Limitations

Contextual stressors selection and methodological considerations

Despite the strengths of the study, there are important limitations as well. It is important to note that the study included a relatively comprehensive list of possible contextual stressors across adolescents' ecology, but still, the list of contextual stressors identified may not capture the full range of stressors that Mexican-origin adolescents are exposed to (Suárez-Orozco et al., 2018). Relatedly, insofar as the use of latent profile analyses is helpful in identifying different typologies of adolescents' contextual stress, latent profile analyses are typically sensitive to the inputs included, model specification, and sample size of the study. Moreover, as highlighted in prior methodological critiques (Bauer & Curran, 2003), LPAs can sometimes identify spurious or unstable profiles that do not represent true underlying subgroups. Thus, the present findings should not be overinterpreted and should instead be viewed as one possible representation of adolescents' contextual stress patterns. Although the selection of contextual stress variables were based on prior research, it may be important for future work to cross-validate across independent samples and extend across other contextual stress domains to investigate whether the current findings are replicated.

Selective attrition and generalizability

Also, attrition analyses indicated that families who remained in the study at Waves 2 and 3 were mothers with higher levels of education and younger adolescents compared with those who dropped out. Although maternal education and adolescent age were statistically controlled in the models, this selective attrition may still limit the generalizability of the findings to families with lower maternal education or older adolescents.

Developmental changes in contextual stress

Moreover, contextual stress experiences may vary over time during adolescence with the development of youth's socio-cognitive skills and changes in their context. Future studies can move forward to consider how the change of contextual stress may impact the fluctuations in psychological or biological well-being. Lastly, future research can focus on the ways in which protective/resilience factors may operate to reduce the influence of contextual stress on psychological and biological well-being.

Conclusion

In sum, the current study examined how Mexican-origin adolescents' patterns of contextual stressors are related to their internalizing symptoms. Study findings showed that adolescents showed typologies based on levels of contextual stress indicators across all domains (i.e., *Occasionally Environmentally Stressed* profile and *Broadly Stressed* profile) or more domain-specific contextual stress (i.e., *Language Brokering Stressed* profile). Specifically, the study found a large body of Mexican-origin youth who experienced only occasional levels of contextual stress and reported the lowest levels of internalizing symptoms both at baseline and over time. The study also found a proportion of youth who showed high levels of contextual stress, and they consistently reported experiencing high levels of internalizing symptoms across adolescence. A third profile was found who showed moderate levels of contextual stress but very high levels of language brokering stress, and they showed high baseline internalizing symptoms but showed reductions in depressive symptoms over time, supporting the hypothesis that family role-based stressors (i.e., language brokering) may influence adolescent mental health in more complex ways than other contextual stressors. More specifically, although language brokering may initially be burdensome, it provides adolescents with a meaningful role as supporters of their families, which helps lessen the perceived burden and contribute positively to their mental health (Burke & Stets, 2009). Over time, adolescents' perceptions of being skilled at language brokering, along with the potential closeness adolescents build with their parents through language brokering, may also help offset early stress and ultimately support improved mental health (Kim, Hou, & Gonzalez, 2017). More research is necessary to understand the patterned configurations of Mexican-origin youths' contextual stress and the implications they have on young people's internalizing symptoms, and the need for interventions targeted toward reducing early-adolescence contextual stress among Mexican-origin youth from immigrant families.

Supplementarymaterial

Supplementary material is available at *Child Development* online.

Data availability

The data, analytic code, and materials necessary to reproduce the analyses presented here are not publicly accessible. Data are available from the first author upon reasonable request. The analyses were not preregistered.

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Author contributions

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Conflicts of interest

None declared.

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